TECHNOVA

Employee Handbook 2026

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1.0 Welcome to Technova

Welcome to the team! At Technova, we build simple, clear, and impactful technology solutions. We are thrilled to have you bring your unique talents, fresh perspective, and personal passion to our growing organization.

1.1 A Message from Our CEO

Our success relies entirely on the creativity, dedication, and collaborative spirit of our people. We work hard to foster an open environment where you feel genuinely valued, fully empowered, and constantly inspired to do your best work. This handbook serves as a foundational guide to understanding our daily culture, shared workplace policies, and the operational expectations we hold as a professional community. Please use it as a personal resource to help navigate your career journey with us. I look forward to working together and achieving great things.

Warmly,
[CEO Name]
Chief Executive Officer

1.2 Purpose of This Handbook

This Employee Handbook provides you with essential everyday information about Technova. It acts as a central reference point for our company procedures, core benefits, and behavioral standards. While this guide is broad, it cannot anticipate every unique situation. The policies outlined here may change over time to adapt to new business goals and legal standards. You can always find the absolute latest version of this document on our internal HR portal.

1.3 Our Commitment to You

Technova is dedicated to building a supportive work experience centered around four foundational ideas:

- Fairness: We treat every single employee with equal consistency, dignity, and respect.
- Opportunity: We actively provide clear pathways for your long-term professional growth.
- Inclusion: We value unique voices and ensure everyone feels safe contributing their ideas.
- Well-being: We actively look out for your health, safety, and personal work-life balance.

1.4 Employment-at-Will

Employment at Technova is strictly on an at-will basis where permitted by law. This means that either you or Technova can choose to end the employment relationship at any time, for any reason, with or without prior notice. This handbook does not serve as an official employment contract and does not guarantee employment for any specific length of time.

2.0 Our Company, Our Culture

Our workplace culture defines how we interact, solve problems, and grow together. We focus on transparency over bureaucracy and action over complex processes.

2.1 Our Mission, Vision, and Values

Our Mission is to simplify complex challenges using intelligent, modern technology solutions. Our Vision is to be a trusted global partner in engineering excellence, recognized for our commitment to quality and integrity.

Our Core Values include:

- Customer Obsession: We listen intently to our clients and design our solutions around their real needs.
- Absolute Integrity: We focus on doing the right thing in every situation, keeping communications honest and clear.
- Continuous Innovation: We actively seek simpler, smarter ways to solve everyday problems.
- One Team Collaboration: We support one another across departments, celebrating our wins together.
- Operational Excellence: We hold our work to high professional standards and always strive for exceptional outcomes.

2.2 Our History

Technova was founded with a foundational goal: to make advanced technology highly accessible and straightforward for businesses everywhere. What started as a dedicated small team has quickly evolved into a fast-growing enterprise serving a diverse, global client base. Our ongoing journey is fueled entirely by technical passion, iterative learning, and a shared commitment to sustainable growth.

2.3 Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI)

We know that a diverse team brings better ideas and a stronger workspace. DEI is a core part of who we are. We intentionally create an environment where every employee has a fair opportunity to thrive, regardless of their background. This mindset applies directly to our hiring, promotion, daily compensation, and training practices.

3.0 Your Employment

This section covers the standard guidelines, classifications, and basic administrative components regarding your employment at Technova.

3.1 Equal Employment Opportunity

Technova is a dedicated Equal Opportunity Employer. We extend equal employment opportunities to all team members and applicants without regard to race, color, religion, sex, national origin, age, physical or mental disability, veteran status, or any other characteristic protected by applicable local laws.

3.2 Employee Classifications

For benefits eligibility and clear payroll administration, we classify our roles as follows:

- Full-Time: Team members scheduled to work our standard 40-hour workweek. They qualify for all company-sponsored benefits.
- Part-Time: Team members scheduled to work fewer than 30 hours per week. Benefit eligibility for these roles is determined by individual employment agreements.
- Exempt: Employees working in professional or managerial roles who are exempt from standard overtime pay provisions and receive a fixed salary.
- Non-Exempt: Employees who are eligible for overtime pay for any hours physically worked beyond 40 within a standard workweek.

3.3 Probationary Period

Your first 90 days of employment serve as an introductory probationary period. This window gives both you and your manager a fair opportunity to see if the role is a great match for your skills and our culture. Regular feedback will be provided during this time.

3.4 Your Employee File

The HR Department securely maintains a personnel file for every employee. This file contains key documents like your original application, role updates, performance reviews, and salary history. You can review your file at any time by coordinating an appointment with HR.

3.5 Promotions and Transfers

We love helping our team members grow. We actively encourage internal promotions and lateral transfers for open roles. Available positions are regularly published on our internal company job board. To apply for an internal transfer, you generally need to be in your current role for at least 12 months while maintaining a strong performance record.

3.6 Performance Management

Our performance review system is continuous and collaborative. It focuses on growth rather than rigid grading:

- Goal Alignment: We set transparent annual goals that align with team objectives.
- Regular Check-ins: Managers and employees have informal, ongoing discussions throughout the year.
- Annual Review: A formal yearly conversation to evaluate key achievements, discuss feedback, and plan for your future career development.

3.7 Separation of Employment

When an employment relationship ends, we aim to make the transition clear and professional.

- Voluntary Resignation: If you choose to leave Technova, we kindly ask that you submit a minimum of two weeks' written notice to your direct manager so we can transition your duties smoothly.
- Involuntary Termination: In rare cases, the company may terminate employment due to prolonged poor performance, severe behavioral misconduct, or broader business restructuring.

4.0 Code of Conduct and Ethics

We maintain a respectful, honest, and ethical workspace. This code outlines how we expect our team to represent themselves and Technova every day.

4.1 Professional Conduct

We expect every employee to act professionally and treat colleagues, clients, and partners with courtesy. Any disruptive, dishonest, or illegal behavior will not be tolerated and can result in disciplinary action up to termination.

4.2 Anti-Harassment and Anti-Bullying

Technova is committed to providing a workspace entirely free from harassment, discrimination, and bullying. We strictly prohibit unwelcome conduct or unfair treatment based on any legally protected personal traits. Bullying behavior that compromises an employee's well-being or safety has no place here.

If you witness or experience harassment, report it immediately to HR or your manager. We investigate all reports promptly and confidentially. Technova strictly prohibits retaliation against anyone making a good-faith report.

4.3 Conflicts of Interest

A conflict of interest happens when your personal activities or relationships interfere with your ability to make objective decisions for Technova. You must avoid these situations. Common examples include:

- Holding a significant financial stake in a direct competitor or vendor.
- Using company resources or your professional title for personal financial gain.
- Directly supervising or hiring a close family member without explicit HR approval.

Please disclose any potential conflicts to HR as soon as you become aware of them.

4.4 Gifts and Entertainment

Exchanging modest business courtesies can build good relationships, but they must never influence objective business choices.

- Receiving Gifts: You may accept minor, token items of nominal value. You must never accept cash, gift cards, or expensive personal items.
- Business Entertainment: Standard meals and basic entertainment are acceptable if they have a direct, clear business purpose.

4.5 Confidentiality and Intellectual Property

While working at Technova, you will handle proprietary information, including code bases, customer data, and strategic roadmaps. You must keep this information completely secure and never share it outside the company. This duty continues even after your employment with us ends. All software, designs, ideas, and documentation you create as part of your job belong exclusively to Technova.

4.6 Whistleblower Policy

We strictly follow all relevant laws and ethics. If you see illegal practices or severe policy violations, report them immediately to HR or Legal. We will protect you completely; we do not tolerate any form of retaliation against employees who speak up in good faith.

4.7 Ethics Case Study: Managing Conflicts

> **Scenario:** *A procurement lead needs to pick a vendor for office equipment. Their sibling runs a local supply business that submits a competitive bid.*

> **Analysis:** *Even if the sibling's bid offers excellent value, the family connection creates a clear appearance of a conflict of interest.*

> **Correct Action:** *The procurement lead must immediately notify their manager and HR in writing. They must remove themselves entirely from the evaluation and voting process so the company can make an unbiased decision.*

5.0 Workplace Policies

Our daily operational guidelines ensure an organized, safe, and productive environment for all teams.

5.1 Working Hours, Breaks, and Overtime

- Standard Hours: Our core business operating hours are 9:00 AM to 5:30 PM, Monday through Friday, though hours may adjust slightly based on specific project needs.
- Rest Breaks: Non-exempt team members receive a paid 15-minute break for every four hours worked, alongside a standard 30-minute unpaid meal break for shifts over five hours. Coordinate break times with your team to maintain smooth operations.
- Overtime: Non-exempt employees receive overtime pay at 1.5 times their standard hourly rate for hours worked beyond 40 in a week. All overtime must be pre-approved by a manager.

5.2 Attendance and Punctuality

Reliable attendance keeps our projects running smoothly. If you expect to be late or absent, inform your manager directly before your scheduled start time. Unexcused, repetitive absences can lead to disciplinary action.

5.3 Dress Code

Our standard daily dress code is business casual. We trust your professional judgment to dress appropriately for a modern office.

- Appropriate Clothing: Tailored trousers, khakis, neat jeans, casual button-downs, polo shirts, and blouses.
- Items to Avoid: Ripped clothing, sportswear, beach footwear, or clothing featuring offensive language or graphics.
- Client Engagements: Wear formal business attire when meeting face-to-face with clients or representing Technova at industry events.

5.4 Health and Safety

Your physical well-being is our priority. Report all hazards, faulty equipment, or injuries to HR immediately. Take time to understand the emergency exit layouts and evacuation plans for your specific building.

5.5 Drug and Alcohol-Free Workplace

To keep our team safe and productive, we strictly prohibit the use, possession, or distribution of illegal drugs and alcohol on company property during work hours. Responsible consumption is permitted only at approved company-hosted evening social events where alcohol is formally served.

5.6 Use of Company Technology and Assets

Laptops, communication channels, and internet access provided by Technova are business tools.

- Personal Use: Brief, occasional personal use is fine as long as it never impacts your work output or violates company security.
- Privacy Expectations: Technova maintains the right to review and monitor company-owned networks and hardware. Employees should have no expectation of privacy regarding data created or stored on company systems.
- Security Rules: Keep your devices secure, do not share passwords, and strictly follow our standard IT security protocols.

5.7 Social Media Policy

We respect your personal freedom to post online, but your words can impact Technova's reputation.

- Protect Data: Never share private company details, source code, or internal plans online.
- Be Respectful: Avoid posting content that discriminates against or defames Technova, your coworkers, or our clients.
- Use Disclaimer: When discussing tech industry trends publicly, clearly state: 'The views expressed are my own and do not represent my employer.'

5.8 Social Media Case Study: Online Activity

> **Scenario:** *An employee posts a message on a public forum complaining about an unreleased system update, naming the project directly.*

> **Analysis:** *This violates our policy by disclosing internal project details and presenting*

Technova in a negative public light.

Correct Action: *Project frustrations must be raised internally through managers or HR channels rather than shared on public platforms.*

6.0 Compensation and Benefits

We provide competitive compensation packages that match industry benchmarks and reflect your professional skills, experience, and performance.

6.1 Payroll Details

Employees are paid on a consistent, predictable schedule. Direct deposit is mandatory for all team members, and detailed digital pay stubs are accessible at any time through our secure HRIS portal.

6.2 Benefits Overview

Technova provides a robust benefits plan to eligible full-time staff, which includes comprehensive medical insurance, retirement savings matches, life insurance options, and wellness program support. Full enrollment details can be accessed via the benefits portal.

6.3 Travel Reimbursements

The company reimburses all reasonable, pre-approved costs incurred during business travel. Ensure you submit detailed expense reports along with valid receipts within the required timeframe after your trip.

7.0 Leave and Time Off

We believe taking time off is vital for long-term productivity and personal health.

- Paid Time Off (PTO): Full-time employees receive an annual allotment of PTO for vacations and personal time, scaling upwards with your tenure.
- Sick Leave: We provide dedicated annual paid sick days to take care of your own health or look after an ill family member.
- Holidays: Technova observes standard paid public holidays each calendar year, with the official schedule published every January.
- Special Leave: We provide structured guidelines for parental leave, bereavement leave, and civic duties like jury duty.

8.0 Employee Development

Continuous learning is central to our engineering mindset. We actively invest in your professional growth.

8.1 Training and Development

We support your career progression through multiple channels:

- Giving you full access to digital learning and technical training platforms.
- Organizing internal technical workshops and knowledge-sharing sessions.
- Sponsoring attendance at key industry conferences and certification programs.

8.2 Tuition Assistance

Eligible employees can apply for financial assistance to complete degrees or professional certifications that directly align with their career path at Technova. Check the HR portal to view application rules and reimbursement caps.

9.0 Problem Resolution and Communication

We believe in open dialogue and fixing workplace problems quickly and transparently.

9.1 Open Door Policy

We maintain an active Open Door Policy. We encourage you to discuss your ideas, career goals, or workplace problems directly with your manager. If you feel uncomfortable doing so, you are always welcome to bring your thoughts to higher management or the HR team.

9.2 Grievance Procedure

When informal talks do not resolve an issue, you can file a formal complaint through our HR department. This ensures a structured, neutral, and fair investigation to find a clear solution.

10.0 Acknowledgment of Receipt

Every employee must sign an acknowledgment form on their first day or after major policy changes. This confirms you have received the handbook, understand where to find company policies, and agree to follow these workplace guidelines during your time with Technova.